



BEFORE

After taking Fort Donelson, the Union Army of West Tennessee advanced toward Corinth, Mississippi, where the Confederates were planning to strike back.

THE ROAD TO SHILOH

On March 4, 1862, the victor at **Fort Donelson** (see [Grant Takes Forts Henry and Donelson](#)), **Ulysses S. Grant**, was relieved of his command by Henry W. Halleck for alleged neglect and inefficiency, but the decision was **reversed** under **pressure from President Lincoln**. By early April, Grant was back in command at Pittsburg Landing on the west bank of the Tennessee. Halleck ordered Don Carlos Buell to march his Army of Ohio to join Grant's six divisions.

Confederate generals **Albert S. Johnston** and **P. G. T. Beauregard** concentrated their forces at Corinth. Reinforced by 15,000 troops under Braxton Bragg, they intended to **attack and destroy Grant before Buell arrived**.

In the run-up to the battle, Grant was culpably complacent. The Union encampment among creeks and swamps at Pittsburg Landing was not protected by field fortifications, one Union division under Lew Wallace was positioned 5 miles (8km) away from the rest, and Grant's headquarters were even farther away, at Savannah. The march of 42,000 Confederates from Corinth was slow and ill-conducted, but Union commanders failed to detect the threat of an imminent attack. The first of Buell's troops reached Savannah on April 5, but there was no rush to move them to Pittsburg Landing.